Did Malta miss the renovation-plan deadline?

Testing the Commission's March 2026 infringement notice on National Building Renovation Plans

THE CLAIM UNDER REVIEW

"…Malta (INFR(2026)2027)… failed to submit their draft National Building Renovation Plan… by the deadline of 31 Decembe

European Commission, March infringements package, 12 March 2026.
Malta and 18 other Member States were given two months to respond.

VERDICT: SUPPORTED *Notice, case number, deadline and period all confirmed*

Version 1.0 · 3 November 2026
Status: no right of reply needed
Prepared from public documents.
Repository: github.com/leandergrech/Mizien

TL;DR

On 12 March 2026 the European Commission announced letters of formal notice to 19 Member States, Malta among them, because they **“failed to submit their draft National Building Renovation Plan (NBRP) to the Commission by the deadline of 31 December 2025.”** We checked each part of that statement against the Commission’s own pages and the Directive. It stands. What it does not tell us is whether Malta has submitted a draft since.

1. **The notice exists as described.** The Commission’s item of 12 March 2026 lists Malta as INFR(2026)2027, with 18 other Member States, and says they have two months to respond [1].
2. **The deadline comes from the Directive.** Article 3 of Directive (EU) 2024/1275 requires the first draft plan by 31 December 2025 [2].
3. **Malta has no entry on the Commission’s plan page.** On 3 November 2026 the page lists 18 Member States and the Walloon Region; Malta is not among them [3]. The page may lag behind submissions, so this is not proof that nothing was sent.
4. **A first step, not a ruling.** A letter of formal notice states the Commission’s view; it can end with a reasoned opinion and later a court case. The claim is about a reporting deadline, not about how many buildings Malta has renovated.
5. **Verdict: supported (high confidence for the claim as worded).** Every element of the statement is confirmed by the Commission’s own text.



19
Member States sent letters of formal notice, 12 March 2026

31 Dec 2025
deadline for the first draft plan (Directive 2024/1275, Article 3)

2 months
period to respond, as stated by the Commission

0
entries for Malta on the Commission’s plan page, 3 Nov 2026

WHAT WOULD MOVE THE VERDICT UP
Nothing: Supported is the top of the scale.

WHAT WOULD MOVE IT DOWN
A Commission or Maltese government document showing that Malta had submitted a draft before 31 December 2025 (the notice would then be wrong), or the Commission closing the case.

IN THIS REPORT

1 The claim and what we could verify
2 Method
3 What the documents show
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5 Testing the claim
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1 The claim and what we could verify

The claim is the Commission's own announcement, published on its Representation in Malta website under the title "March infringements package", dated 12 March 2026 [1]. We read the whole item. It is the Commission's text; the quotation marks below are its words. The record's first source, an EU Reporter re-publication, refused our download and was not used.

What the Commission says	Where	Access
"The European Commission decided to open infringement procedures by sending a letter of formal notice to Belgium (INFR(2026)2014), Czechia (INFR(2026)2016), Germany (INFR(2026)2017) … Malta (INFR(2026)2027) … as they failed to submit their draft National Building Renovation Plan (NBRP) to the Commission by the deadline of 31 December 2025." (19 Member States are named; we abbreviate the list.)	[1]	Read in full
"These Member States have two months to respond to the letters of formal notice. In the absence of a satisfactory response, the Commission may decide to issue a reasoned opinion."	[1]	Read in full

SCOPE NOTE
We test the four facts in the statement: the notice, Malta's case number, the deadline and the response period. We do not rate whether the Commission's view is right on the merits; that is for Malta to answer and, ultimately, for the Court of Justice. The claim is about a reporting deadline, not about renovation itself.

2 Method

Question. Is the Commission's statement consistent with its own register of plans and with the law that sets the deadline?

Evidence. The Commission's news item [1]; Article 3(3) of Directive (EU) 2024/1275 (the German text, read at gesetze.legal, because EUR-Lex refused our requests; the Commission's energy site and REHVA give the same 31 December 2025 date) [2]; the Commission's "National Building Renovation Plans" page, read in full on 3 November 2026, which lists every draft plan received [3]; and the Commission's first assessment of 14 July 2026 [4]. The counts are recomputed by *tools/cc-153-report/calc.py* from *data/cc-153/*. There is no peer-reviewed literature on this question; the evidence is official documents (grade C). The search log is in *literature/CC-153/notes.md*.

Grades. Official documents are grade C. **Verdicts** follow the five-point scale in Appendix A.

3 What the documents show

The notice and the deadline

The 12 March item names 19 Member States and their case numbers; Malta's is INFR(2026)2027 [1]. Article 3(3) of the Directive says Member States submit the first draft of the plan to the Commission by 31 December 2025 [2]. The notice came 71 days after the deadline.

What the Commission's plan page shows

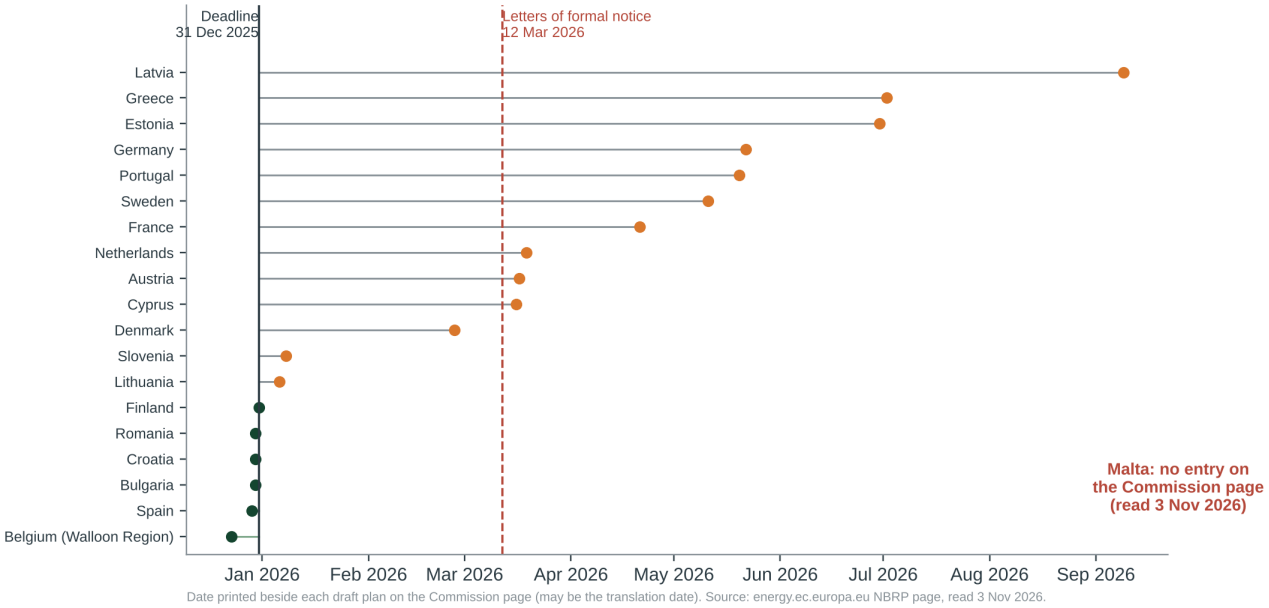


Figure 1. Every draft plan listed on the Commission's page, by the date printed beside it. Malta has no entry. Six entries are dated on or before 31 December 2025; thirteen are later, ten of them after the 12 March notice.

Of the 19 notified States, 11 now have an entry (some under their own name, Belgium only for the Walloon Region); eight do not: Czechia, Hungary, Ireland, Italy, Luxembourg, Malta, Poland and Slovakia [3]. The Commission's July assessment says 15 EU countries and the Walloon Region submitted between December 2025 and May 2026 [4]; later entries on the page (Estonia, Greece, Latvia) came after that. The page does not say whether each printed date is the submission or the date of the English translation.

4 Where the evidence points different ways

Q1 Has Malta still not submitted?

NOT SHOWN EITHER WAY

EVIDENCE FOR THE CLAIM'S IMPRESSION

Malta has no entry on the Commission's plan page on 3 November 2026, and we found no Commission or Maltese government statement that a draft was submitted.

EVIDENCE AGAINST

The page may lag behind submissions, and the infringement register entry for INFR(2026)2027 (its current stage) could not be read. A LinkedIn post and a legal-news summary mention an escalation in October 2026 ◆ (second-hand, not verified).

WHY THEY DIFFER, AND WHAT IT MEANS HERE

For this claim: not needed. The claim concerns the deadline and the March notice, which are documented; it does not say Malta has not submitted since.

Q2 Does missing the draft deadline mean Malta is not renovating?

DIFFERENT QUESTION

EVIDENCE FOR THE CLAIM'S IMPRESSION

The plans are the Directive's tool for renovation pipelines; a missing draft delays the Commission's assessment [1].

EVIDENCE AGAINST

Malta has a renovation strategy and grant schemes (a search found the Irrinova Darek scheme, aligned by MaltaToday with the Long-term Renovation Strategy 2050; not read in full). Those do not replace the plan, and the notice does not rate them.

WHY THEY DIFFER, AND WHAT IT MEANS HERE

For this claim: the statement is limited to the deadline; we do not rate renovation performance.

5 Testing the claim

Sub-claim	What the evidence shows	Rating
A. Malta, with 18 other Member States, received a letter of formal notice (INFR(2026)2027) in March 2026	The Commission's item of 12 March 2026 names 19 States; Malta is INFR(2026)2027 [1].	SUPPORTED
B. The notice was for not submitting the draft National Building Renovation Plan, due by 31 December 2025	The Commission's text says so; Article 3 of Directive 2024/1275 sets the date [1][2].	SUPPORTED
C. Malta has two months to respond	Stated in the Commission's item [1]. Whether Malta has responded is not documented.	SUPPORTED

6 Verdict and requests for evidence

VERDICT

SUPPORTED

Every element of the statement is confirmed by the Commission's own text and the Directive. Confidence: high for the claim as worded.

Why. (1) The Commission's item contains the quoted statement. (2) The Directive sets the 31 December 2025 date. (3) Malta's absence from the Commission's plan page on 3 November 2026 is consistent with the notice, though not proof of the current state.

What this verdict does not say. It does not say that Malta's buildings are poorly renovated, that the Commission's view is final, or that anyone acted in any particular way. A letter of formal notice is a first procedural step.

Evidence we are asking for

- ☐ Whether Malta submitted a draft NBRP, and when.
- ☐ The current stage of INFR(2026)2027 in the Commission's infringement decisions register.
- ☐ Whether and when a public consultation on Malta's draft was held (Article 3(4) of the Directive).

7 Limitations

- EUR-Lex refused our requests; the Directive's Article 3 was read in the German text at gesetze.legal, and the date was cross-checked on the Commission's energy site, REHVA and Build-Up. We did not read the English official text.
- The Commission's plan page may lag behind submissions and prints a date whose meaning (submission or translation) is not stated.
- The Commission's infringement register entry could not be read; later stages of the case are unverified.
- We did not search Maltese parliamentary or ministry records exhaustively (see the notes for what was searched).
- The statement concerns a reporting obligation, not renovation performance.

References

[1] European Commission, Representation in Malta (12 March 2026). March infringements package: Commission calls on Member States to submit their draft National Building Renovation Plans. https://malta.representation.ec.europa.eu/news/march-infringements-package-2026-03-12_en

[2] Directive (EU) 2024/1275 of 24 April 2024 on the energy performance of buildings (recast), Article 3(3). German text read at gesetze.legal; date cross-checked at the Commission's energy site. https://gesetze.legal/eu/rl_2024_1275_eu/3

[3] European Commission, DG Energy. National Building Renovation Plans (page read 3 Nov 2026). https://energy.ec.europa.eu/topics/energy-efficiency/energy-performance-buildings/national-building-renovation-plans_en

[4] European Commission, DG Energy (14 July 2026). National Building Renovation Plans: the Commission's first assessment. https://energy.ec.europa.eu/news/national-building-renovation-plans-commissions-first-assessment-2026-07-14_en

[5] Miżien. Data and calculations: data/cc-153/; tools/cc-153-report/calc.py.

Appendix A: series standards and verdict scale

Every investigation in this series follows the same rules so that verdicts are comparable and challengeable.

Verdict	Meaning
SUPPORTED	Evidence consistently backs the claim as stated.
LARGELY SUPPORTED	Backed by the evidence, with minor caveats that do not change the substance.
NOT SUBSTANTIATED	Stated more strongly than the evidence offered or available allows. May be true in some conditions but has not been shown.
MISLEADING	Omits material facts so that the overall impression is inaccurate, even if individual statements are defensible.
CONTRADICTED	The available evidence points against the claim.

Confidence

High: multiple independent lines of evidence agree. **Moderate**: evidence is relevant but incomplete or indirect. **Low**: evidence is thin, second-hand or conflicting.

Evidence grades

A experiment · B observational study with a control or gradient · C review, guidance or official statistics · D assertion or anecdote. ◆ marks a source known only second-hand.

Standards

- **Quote the speaker, not the headline,** with outlet and date, and link the original where possible.
- **Separate the claim from the evidence offered for it,** and say who made which statement.
- **Grade the evidence** and show differing views side by side where the evidence is unsettled.
- **State what we could not access or verify,** and what would change the verdict either way.
- **Ask for the missing evidence** in specific, answerable requests.
- **Offer a right of reply** where a check finds a claim Not substantiated, Misleading or Contradicted (or a pledge Not measurable, Off track or Missed), before wider circulation, and append responses.
- **Correct errors openly** with a version number and change log.
- **Whistle-blow only on evidence:** a verdict of *Misleading* or *Contradicted* requires documents or data that can be shown, not inference.
- **Check every side.** Government, opposition, NGOs and developers are held to the same standard.

Appendix B: revision log

Version	Date	Change
1.0	3 Nov 2026	First issue. Verdict: Supported; no right of reply needed.